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GULF NEWS



NATION | P4

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THE VIEWS | P9

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BUSINESS | P7

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Dr. Maryam Darwish, MD, Hematology, Oncology Center, Sheikh Khalifa Specialty Hospital, explains



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MOHAMMAD VISITS IDEX 2025

■ His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, visited IDEX 2025 yesterday. Shaikh Mohammad toured the exhibition and expressed his deep pride in the participation of national companies. On the second day of IDEX and NAVDEX 2025 yesterday, five deals worth a total of Dh5.8 billion were signed, taking the value of deals over two days to a record Dh9.77 billion. **SEE ALSO P6**

Safety urged as rain hits UAE

More showers today as authorities advice caution on wet roads

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter
MANUEL ALMARIO
Senior News Editor

The UAE experienced light to moderate rainfall yesterday, prompting safety warnings for motorists as wet roads created hazardous driving conditions.

Rainfall swept across multiple regions from morning until afternoon, offering a refreshing change in the weather. Areas including Ajman, Qarnain Island, Diynah Island, Sir Abu Nu'Ayr Island, and Das Island

saw light showers, while Dubai International Airport and Jebel Ali were also affected. The Al Ruwais, Al Dhafra region experienced rain in the afternoon.

Tips to stay safe

Meanwhile, Dubai authorities have issued a series of safety guidelines for residents to stay safe on the roads.

The Dubai Health Authority (DHA) advised residents to "stay informed about weather forecasts, dress warmly, and stay indoors if possible".

For those who need to drive, the DHA urged caution: "Avoid driving in heavy rain, but if you must, drive safely. Never drive through flooded roads."

Meanwhile, Dubai Police issued essential tips for safe driving in rainy weather. Drivers

have been advised to "turn on low beam headlights to stay visible" and "check brakes after driving through water." The police also urged motorists to "stay away from valleys and flooded areas" and "make sure windshield wipers are working."

The Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) also urged residents to plan ahead to ensure road safety. "With heavy rain expected in the coming days, be sure to follow safety tips and don't skip regular car check-ups," the RTA said in a post.

Looking ahead, the National Center of Meteorology (NCM) has forecast partly cloudy weather today, with clouds expected to be heavier in the north, bringing light rainfall in some areas.



ENTERTAINMENT

Renée Zellweger returns to remind us why it's okay to be imperfect | P15

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India-Pakistan tie headlines Champions Trophy return

Pakistan set to host the world's best in long-awaited event

DUBAI

BY A.K.S. SATISH
Sports Editor

The wait is finally over. The Champions Trophy is back, and this time it's a game-changer. After an eight-year hiatus, the tournament returns, bringing top-tier international cricket to Pakistan for the first time in 29 years. A momentous occasion for both the sport and the nation.

In 2017, Pakistan stunned the world with a dramatic victory over India in the final when the tournament was last held in London. Fast-forward to now, and after overcoming multiple obstacles, the Champions Trophy is set to kick off in Karachi today, with Pakistan

taking on New Zealand in a thrilling opener.

Dubai in the spotlight

While all eyes are on Pakistan, tournament favourites India have chosen Dubai as their battleground. The Dubai International Stadium will host some of the most anticipated matchups, including the epic India-Pakistan clash on February 23, one that will bring the world to a standstill.

Afghanistan, the rising powerhouse of world cricket, are ready to make their mark as debutants. Considered second only to the World Cup, this high-octane event runs until March 9, and the stakes couldn't be higher. Bangladesh complete the Asian quartet, while an understrength but determined Australia, South Africa, and England round out the formidable line-up. **SEE ALSO P13**

Russia, US teams move to end Ukraine war

FIRST ROUND OF TALKS IN RIYADH HELD WITHOUT KYIV

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Top US and Russian officials met in Saudi Arabia for the first round of Ukraine talks — without Kyiv's participation — as President Donald Trump pushes for a swift resolution, risking tensions with European allies.

After over four hours of negotiations, both sides pledged to form high-level negotiating teams to end the conflict "as soon as possible." US Secretary of State Marco Rubio hinted at restoring diplomatic staffing, which had been slashed over espionage and hacking disputes.

Russian Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov told the US in talks that it opposed any Nato member sending troops to Ukraine as part of a ceasefire, calling it "unacceptable." He described the talks as "very useful," saying Washington now "better understands" Moscow's position.

The US and Russia also signalled a willingness to lift sanc-



AFP

■ Senior US, Russian and Saudi officials during their meeting at Riyadh's Diriyah Palace yesterday.

tions imposed on Russia, a move likely to deepen rifts with European allies who insist the restrictions must remain.

Lavrov said both sides showed a "mutual desire to find concrete solutions" to economic barriers.

The State Department's readout of the talks in Riyadh highlighted the potential for future US-Russia cooperation on "historic economic and investment opportunities" that will emerge once the conflict is resolved. Rubio also made clear that sanctions removal was on the table.

Ukraine reacted with outrage. President Volodymyr Zelensky cancelled a trip to Saudi Arabia,

calling the talks a "surprise" and demanding Kyiv's inclusion.

UAE welcomes talks

The UAE welcomed the talks and expressed hope that they will serve as a significant step towards bridging differences, fostering communication and advancing dialogue to bring an end to the conflict. The Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) commended the efforts of Saudi Arabia in hosting the talks, which reflect the Kingdom's commitment to supporting international peace efforts, and achieving global stability and prosperity, WAM reported. **SEE ALSO P11**

INDIA

India and Qatar aim to double trade in the next five years | P12



MIDDLE EAST

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SPORT

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